Start with the work you want

Use an existing summary of your experience and preferences, or write a short brief below. Choose page 2 for AI or page 3 for manual search, then continue to page 4.

Describe the work behind the title

Describe your experience and the projects, decisions or responsibilities you want to take on next. Include a few related job titles if you have them.

Separate requirements from preferences

List your must-haves separately from preferences you could be flexible about.

A short brief if you need one

Work I want to explore: [responsibilities or types of roles]
Where I would work: [location or remote region]
Relevant experience: [short summary]
Must have: [requirements]
Would prefer: [preferences]
Optional starting points: [titles, sources, employers or saved openings]

Use the Job Search Starter

Choose “I have a summary” to add yours, or “Help me build my brief” to enter your details. Then choose “Use my AI” or “Search myself”. The next two pages walk through each route.

The starter prepares search links and prompts; you or your assistant run the searches.

Use your own notes if you prefer

The brief and both search methods work without the starter. Keep confidential work and other people’s private information out of anything you share.

Job Search Starter: martaavilesmontalvo.github.io/job-search-starter/

Ask your AI to run a first search

On the starter, choose “Use my AI” and “Prepare my prompt”. Review it, select “Copy prompt”, and send it to an assistant with web search enabled. Or copy the prompt below and add your summary or brief. If your assistant cannot browse, use page 3.

Copy this prompt and add your starting point

Use my summary or brief below to find current openings. Use my experience, the work I did and the responsibility I held. Suggest a few related titles or work phrases, explain why, and test them against actual descriptions.

Ask me for missing details that would change the search. Otherwise, flag what you don’t know and proceed. Keep firm requirements separate from preferences. Do not invent experience or treat an unmentioned skill as a missing ability.

Search employer careers pages, broad and specialist job boards, and the wider web. Find suitable sources if I have not named any. Include saved openings, alerts and recruiter leads I provide; do not assume access to my accounts. Tell me what you searched and which sources you could not access or did not check.

Find each promising vacancy on the employer’s site and read the full description. Check for a current vacancy listing or working application form. A description alone does not confirm availability; broken links or conflicting evidence remain unverified. Keep unverified leads separate and explain what needs checking.

Explain why each role is relevant based on its responsibilities and scope. Only rule it out if you can confirm it fails a firm requirement, and show why. Keep preferences flexible and mark any requirement the posting doesn’t address as unknown.

Combine duplicate copies of one vacancy, keeping different jobs at the same employer separate. Retain still-active saved openings. Use any search history I provide to identify new, repeated and changed results. Keep roles I applied to or declined separate. Say if you have no history.

For each lead, give employer, title, job ID if available, employer link, discovery source, date checked and availability evidence. Include the work, location, arrangement, posted pay, its time period and whether it is base or total pay, why it is relevant, unanswered questions and a suggested next step. Do not guess bonus or equity. Distinguish no relevant results from an incomplete search. Do not apply or contact anyone.

MY SUMMARY OR BRIEF:
[Provide your starting point here.]

Review the results

Open a few employer links and compare the responsibilities and requirements with your experience. Tell the assistant which results missed and why; page 4 has an example. Ask it to update your brief with the changes you agree on. Include that brief and saved openings when you start a new chat.

Repeat the search

If your assistant supports scheduled web searches, specify the days, time, time zone and where you want the results. Check that the task was created and its first run worked. Use your latest brief and pause it when your search ends. Scheduling happens in your assistant, not the starter.

Example scheduling instructions for ChatGPT

Run your search yourself

Choose “Search myself”, enter the work and location, then select “Build my search plan”. Scroll to “Your manual search plan”.

Open a search

Under “Discover openings and employers”, select “Open query”. Try the related titles and work phrases in your plan.

The links won’t apply every filter. Check location, where remote employees can live, office attendance and your other must-haves on the job board and employer posting.

Look beyond the first source

Use “Check employer career pages” and “Find relevant specialist or local sources” to look beyond the first results. Search those sites using the titles and responsibilities in your brief, and include useful alerts or leads people send you.

Without the starter, try “[role or responsibility] jobs [location]” in a web search, then check employer sites and a board for your field.

Check and save promising openings

Find the exact opening on the employer’s site by title or job ID. Read the full description and check for a current listing or working application form. Note any requirements or availability you cannot confirm.

Save the employer link, date checked, why it interests you and questions to ask. Save each opening once, even if it appears on several sites. Before preparing an application, compare the requirements with your experience; add relevant examples missing from your summary.

Keep your plan

Select “Copy search plan” and save it with useful openings in your own notes. The starter won’t save jobs you find on other sites.

To change the search, edit the terms on the sites you use, or update your brief and select “Build my search plan” for new links. Keep saved openings that are still active. See page 4 for a worked example.

Adjust the search based on what you find

A worked example: project coordination

Fictional example

Work you want: coordinating project plans, timelines and dependencies.

First search: “project coordinator [location] jobs”

Results: mostly jobs booking appointments.

Next searches to try:
“project delivery coordinator [location] jobs”
“implementation coordinator [location] jobs”

Read the next descriptions for responsibility for project plans, deadlines and dependencies. Don’t exclude a role just because it includes scheduling; check whether scheduling supports project delivery or is most of the job.

Give your AI the same feedback

If you’re using AI, you can send:

These results are mostly booking appointments. I want to coordinate project delivery, including plans, timelines and dependencies. Suggest changes to the search terms or sources and explain why. Use the changes I agree on in the next search.

Change sources when needed, and keep what works

Try “[field] job board [location]” to find a specialist board, or search employers doing the work you want. Ask your AI which sources it checked and which it could not access.

Keep useful terms and sources in your brief, with a short note about what changed and why. Bring saved openings and application history into the next search, and recheck openings before acting.